NowAI backend design in plain language

Design proposal. Nothing here is built yet. Prices are from public pages on 6 November 2026. The picture version is `demo/NowAI_Blueprint.html`.

The one-minute version

Clients send photos in. Agents read them and propose entries. An accountant approves. Only then do they enter the books. Nothing reaches the ledger, and nothing leaves to an outside system, without the accountant's click. That approval queue is the most important part of the design.

The eight layers, from outside to inside

1. **Front doors.** A WhatsApp number for clients, a web app for the accountant, and later a 1C connector. 1C is the accounting software many Azerbaijani firms already use.
2. **Intake.** A gateway and queue (a queue is a waiting list for jobs), a document reader that turns a photo into fields, and importers for bank and e-qaimə files.
3. **Agent brain.** Each agent is one narrow job: Books at launch, then Cash and Tax, then People and Comply. A model router picks the cheapest model that can do the job. A workflow engine keeps jobs in order. An internal Builder agent helps write new rule packs.
4. **Knowledge.** Client memory, a rules library and a supplier map. They sit apart from the AI model so the accountant can check and correct them.
5. **Records.** The ledger (the book of accounts), a document store for the original photos, and an audit trail of who did what.
6. **Human approval queue.** The gate. Every proposed entry, reminder or payment waits here with its evidence and a confidence score. The accountant approves, edits or rejects.
7. **Outside systems.** E-taxes and e-qaimə (files only), banks (files at launch, an API later), a licensed payment partner (planned, legally unconfirmed; Epoint and Payriff are candidates) and the WhatsApp provider.
8. **Foundation.** Hosting (undecided), secrets and a key proxy, a test and simulation harness, monitoring and backups.

What exists when

- **Day 1: 21 of 29 parts.** One agent (Books), the gate, the ledger, files for banks and the state.
- **Month 12:** Cash, Tax, the Builder, the workflow engine, the 1C connector, bank APIs and the payment partner.
- **Year 3:** People and Comply agents.

One receipt, nine steps

The client photographs a receipt. It arrives by WhatsApp, is saved and queued, read by a small model, checked automatically, turned into a proposed entry, approved by the accountant, written to the ledger and logged, and the client gets a confirmation.

- **Clean receipt:** Haiku 5.5 reads it. About $0.002.
- **Hard receipt** (blurry, Azerbaijani and Russian mixed): the check fails, the reader escalates to Sonnet 5.5, about $0.06, and the accountant gets a flag.

How the cost adds up, using Claude prices per million tokens (Haiku $0.10 in and $0.50 out, Sonnet $2 and $10, Opus $4 and $20):

- Clean: read 5,000 in and 600 out, code 4,000 in and 300 out, verify 3,000 in and 200 out. Total $0.00175, rounded to $0.002.
- Hard: read 9,000 in and 1,500 out, code 8,000 in and 800 out. Total $0.057, rounded to $0.06.
- Blend of 80 percent clean and 20 percent hard: $0.0136 a document.

Cost per client, and an open gap

60 documents a month x $0.0136 = $0.82, plus 10 WhatsApp messages ($0.21) and $0.30 of other model use = about $1.33, or about 2.3 AZN, against revenue of about 14.5 AZN.

The financial model says something different. It puts the direct cost per client at about 5.7 AZN a month. The model uses a cautious reading cost and counts more cost lines. The two numbers have not been reconciled. Treat 2.3 AZN as the low case and 5.7 AZN as the safe case until they are.

Accuracy on real Azerbaijani receipts is untested, and no benchmark exists. The 80/20 split is a guess. The bigger cost is people, not AI.

Build order

9. Intake and the document reader, tested on 200+ real receipts.
10. Books agent, ledger and the approval queue.
11. Accountant web app and the audit trail.
12. Bank and e-qaimə file importers.
13. Month 12 onward: Cash, Tax, 1C connector, bank APIs, payment partner.
14. Year 3: People, Comply, more countries as rule packs.

Who owns what

Backend engineers own the agents, gateway, router and the gate. Integration engineers own WhatsApp, banks, state files and the payment partner. A front-end engineer owns the accountant web app. Implementation staff own client memory and the supplier map. A domain expert owns the rules library. An infrastructure engineer owns secrets, monitoring and backups. An evaluation owner runs the test harness. The tech lead owns the ledger, document store, audit trail and hosting.

Limits that shape the design

- Azerbaijani law requires a certified chief accountant for firms that need one. Software cannot sign or file, and NowAI never holds a client's ASAN İmza.
- NowAI never holds client money.
- No public e-taxes, e-qaimə or EMAS API was found, so these are files the accountant handles.
- No rule requiring servers in Azerbaijan was found. A lawyer must confirm, because Claude API calls send client documents abroad.

Biggest risks and unknowns

- Reading accuracy on real Azerbaijani receipts is unmeasured.
- Direct cost per client: 2.3 versus 5.7 AZN, still to reconcile.
- The legal route for the payment partner is unconfirmed.
- Hosting location is undecided.
- Volumes per client (60 documents) are assumed.

The route to $1B in one paragraph

$1B at 10 times revenue is $100M a year. At about 80 AZN a client a month that takes about 177,000 firms. At the prices buyers paid per client ($3,000 to $3,900) it takes about 257,000 to 333,000 firms. Steps 1 and 2 (403 clients in year 1, 2,477 in year 3) are the model's Base case. Steps 3 to 5 (24,000, 90,000, 180,000 clients) are what you would need to believe, not a forecast. On Azerbaijani subscriptions alone the Base case runs out of cash around month 45 and shows no profit within 60 months, so new funding and new countries are not optional. A strategic sale is the most likely good outcome: about $7M at 2,500 clients and about $72M at 24,000 clients at Conta Azul's price per client.

Sources

Anthropic pricing page (confirmed 6 November 2026); `AI_Company_Model.xlsx`, sheet "Path to $1B"; `research/Latest_1B_Companies.md`; the backend research file for parts, receipt steps and team ownership.